

22, The Superficial Revival of Classical Society in Andalusia

Under Muslim rule in Andalusia, a rare but fundamentally non-essential phenomenon was observed. During the Umayyad Dynasty's rule over Spain, classical forms seemingly experienced a temporary resurrection in the southwestern corner of the European continent, and the prosperity in economy, culture, and art earned Andalusia immense renown during this period.

It is indeed perplexing that such a situation emerged under Muslim rule three centuries after the collapse of the Western Roman Empire and the subsequent entry and rule of the Visigoths in this region. I believe this should be understood from two distinct perspectives.

First, the historical trajectory of the Iberian Peninsula inherently cannot be equated with that of Western Europe's core region—namely, the French territories ruled by the Frankish Kingdom. The Iberian Peninsula is dominated by plateaus and mountain ranges; the Meseta Central (Castilian Plateau) alone accounts for 60% of the peninsula's total area. It is frequently noted that many American Western films were shot in the arid regions of central Spain, where population density is exceedingly low. Were it not for the sanctuary provided by such complex topographical features, the Christian kingdoms in the northern peninsula might not have survived the vanguard of the Islamic armies.

However, as previously stated, the cover provided by a geographical environment littered with mountains and plateaus inevitably allowed a massive number of indigenous **communities** (社群) to drift outside state administration, rendering rulers incapable of significantly influencing them. The regions with a developed agricultural economy were confined to the river valleys or coastal areas along the peninsula's periphery. This is a far cry from the conditions in France, where plains constitute two-thirds of the national territory and are highly optimal for agricultural production. During the early modern period between 1500 and 1700, although the Iberian Peninsula was roughly the same size as metropolitan France, the former's population was only about one-third of the latter's. Similarly distinct from France, the Kingdom of Castile and the Kingdom of Spain historically lacked a fixed capital for a prolonged period, possessing only an itinerant court that moved with the monarch.

Prior to the Muslim conquest, during the Visigothic Kingdom's rule over Iberia, the process of **feudalization** was already relatively sluggish. In an era characterized by universal urban decay, the Visigoths constructed several new cities and preserved Roman-era urban culture, such as public baths. The Visigothic Kingdom produced a cohort of outstanding scholars, the most renowned being Isidore of Seville (Isidro), who is also one of the most well-known medieval European scholars in China. The nobility and rulers were well-educated and zealous about maintaining classical culture. These realities point to an explicit conclusion: prior to the Muslim conquest of the vast majority of the Iberian Peninsula, the degree of **feudalization** in the region was not high, and the characteristics of a **late-classical society** more or less persisted.

Second, the new variables introduced by the Muslim conquerors were also conducive to the formation of Andalusia's zenith during the 10th-century rule of the Caliphate of Córdoba. Examples include the diversification of communities, encompassing the Umayyads who arrived to rule, the Berbers and European Slavs (*Saqaliba*) who arrived as military forces, and the Jewish communities that played a monumental role in international trade. Certain new technologies originating from the Near East were introduced to the Iberian Peninsula, resulting in significant development in both agriculture and handicrafts. The Iberian Peninsula was integrated into the trade networks of the

Islamic world, and the initiation and prosperity of the Trans-Saharan Trade brought massive quantities of precious metal currency to the Córdoba regime adjacent to North Africa.

These mutations curbed the **natural economy** to varying degrees, allowing the splendor of a **classical society** to reappear in this corner of Europe. Abd al-Rahman III, who elevated the Umayyad regime from an Emirate to a Caliphate, fully leveraged all the aforementioned favorable factors to consolidate central financial and military power in order to reconstruct imperial authority.

However, such prosperity ultimately could not guarantee the eternal preservation of the Umayyad dynasty's rule. After all, the feudal manorial economy had already begun to develop in Iberia, and it would not be thoroughly suppressed simply due to Muslim governance. The high degree of commercial circulation within the medieval Islamic world would ultimately only serve as an obstruction to its progression toward an early modern society.

The historical reality was that the Caliphate of Córdoba possessed the mere facade of a **classical empire**, yet in practice, it was entirely incapable of organizing a "citizen army" like a genuine classical state. The empire was excessively reliant militarily on mercenaries and armed slaves, which is inherently a core characteristic of the terminal phase of classical empires. The Caliphate of Córdoba moved toward disintegration at the dawn of the 11th century. Meanwhile, the Christian kingdoms in the north, which had long been highly passive, genuinely began to develop a feudal system akin to other regions of Western Europe. Accompanying the arrival of the European High Middle Ages, the bugle for the Christian Reconquista (重新征服) of the peninsula was sounded.

22, 安达卢西亚古典社会表面的复兴

在穆斯林统治下的安达卢西亚 (Andalusia), 人们观察到了一种难得的, 但是并非本质的景象。在伍麦叶王朝统治西班牙时期, 古典形态似乎在欧洲大陆的西南角暂时复活了, 经济、文化和艺术的繁荣让这个时期的安达卢西亚享有盛名。在西罗马帝国瓦解, 西哥特人进入并统治这个地区三个世纪后在穆斯林统治下出现这种情况的确令人费解。我认为应该从两个方面进行理解, 首先是伊比利亚半岛的历史进程本来也不能视为与西欧的中心地区, 也就是法兰克王国统治的法国地区相同。伊比利亚半岛多高原和山脉, 仅仅一个中央卡斯蒂利亚高原就占了整个半岛面积的 60%, 据说很多美国西部片都取景自西班牙中部的荒漠地区, 那里人口密度极低。如果不是这样复杂地貌特征的庇护, 半岛北部的基督教王国当年也未必能在伊斯兰大军的兵锋下存活下来。然而就如之前所说, 这种山区高原遍布的地理环境掩护下必然有大量土著社群游离在国家行政之外, 统治者难以影响他们。农业经济发达地区位于半岛边缘的河谷或者沿海地区。这与法国那种平原面积占国土 2/3, 并且极为适宜农业生产的条件差之远矣。在近代早期的 1500 年到 1700 年间, 尽管伊比利亚半岛的面积和法国本土差不多大, 但是前者的人口却只有后者的 1/3 左右。同样与法国不同的是, 卡斯蒂利亚王国以及西班牙王国长期没有固定的首都, 只有随着君主移动的行在。在穆斯林征服之前, 西哥特王国统治伊比利亚时封建化的进程就已经较慢。在城市普遍衰落的年代, 西哥特人兴建了一些新的城市, 并保留了浴场这样罗马时期的城市文化。西哥特王国诞生了一批杰出的学者, 以塞维利亚的伊西多尔最为知名 (Isidro, 他在中国也是知名度最高的中世纪欧洲学者之一), 贵族和统治者的教育情况良好, 并且热衷于维持古典文化。这些事实指向了一个显然的事实, 在穆斯林征服伊比利亚半岛绝大部分地区之前, 该地区的封建化程度并不高, 晚期古典社会的特征或多或少仍然存在。

其次, 作为征服者的穆斯林带来的新变化也有利于形成科尔多瓦哈里发国统治时安达卢西亚在十世纪的鼎盛景象。例如多元化的社群, 包括来到这里统治的伍麦叶人, 作为军事力量来此的柏柏尔人和欧洲的斯拉夫人, 以及在国际贸易中发挥重大作用的犹太社区。一些来自近东地区的新技术被引进了伊比利亚半岛, 农业和手工业都有了比较大的发展。伊比利亚半岛被接入伊斯兰世界的贸易网络中, 跨撒哈拉贸易的开辟和繁荣为临近北非的科尔多瓦政权带来了大量贵金属货币。这些变化都在不同程度上遏制了自然经济, 使得一种古典社会的辉煌再次出现在欧洲的角落。使得伍麦叶政权从一个埃米尔国发展成为一个哈里发国的阿卜杜拉赫曼三世 (Abd al-Rahman III) 就充分利用了以上所有有利因素巩固中央的

财政和军事力量以重建权威。不过这样的繁华终归不能保证伍麦叶家族江山永固，封建庄园经济毕竟已经在伊比利亚发展起来了，而且并不会因为穆斯林的统治就被彻底压制。中世纪伊斯兰世界的高度商业流通最终只能作为其迈向近现代社会的阻碍。事实就是科尔多瓦哈里发国家有一个古典帝国的表面，实际上完全不能像真正的古典帝国一样组织一支“公民军队”，帝国在军事上太过依赖于雇佣兵和奴隶武装，这原本就是古典帝国终结期的特征。科尔多瓦哈里发国在 11 世纪初走向瓦解，长期以来在北方十分被动的基督教王国却真正开始发展出了类似于西欧其他地区的封建体制，伴随着欧洲中世纪盛期的到来，基督教重新征服半岛的号角吹响了。